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Organization and Classification Program Reference Guide

Classification Evaluation by a Job Evaluation Committee

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OCHRO

Office of the Chief Human Resources Officer

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Purpose

This reference guide is intended to build on the information in previous modules to:

- a. familiarize the Organization and Classification (OC) advisor with the job evaluation committee process
- b. enable OC advisors to bring the most appropriate committee members together to include different perspectives in the committee debate to reach a consensus on the job evaluation by all members of the committee
- c. explore possible challenges and how to overcome them for successful outcomes

Intended audience

This reference guide is for three groups in the organization and classification community:

- a. The OC classification trainees who have not yet completed the OC mandatory training:
This document is a source of pre-training information and a preview of the core activities and principles of OC work, which forms the basis of the training.
- b. Participants to the OC mandatory training:
This document forms a core element of the training alongside the practical, scenario-based elements that form the training
- c. Accredited OC advisors:
This document is meant to serve the entire OC community as an ongoing reference outlining expectations, recommendations and requirements of the Classification Program, to support consistency in outcomes while allowing for flexibility in approach to activities in a departmental context

Chapter 1. Classification decision process overview

The classification decision process map (Figure 1) illustrates the major steps involved in rendering a classification decision. While the process allows for variation to address the specific needs of individual cases, standardization of the overall approach is intended to drive consistent, high quality service delivery. This reference guide focuses on using the process in an evaluation by a job evaluation committee.

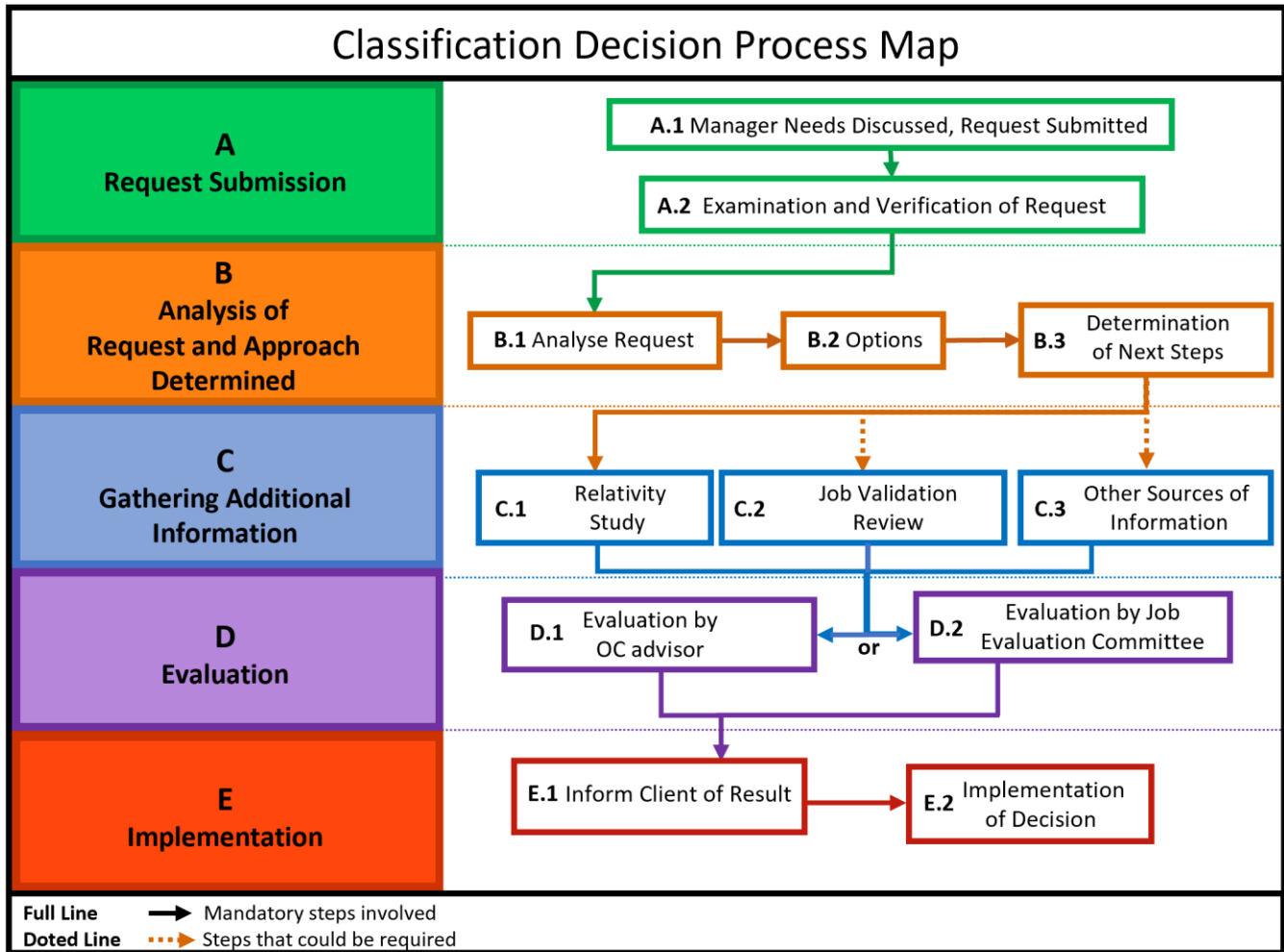
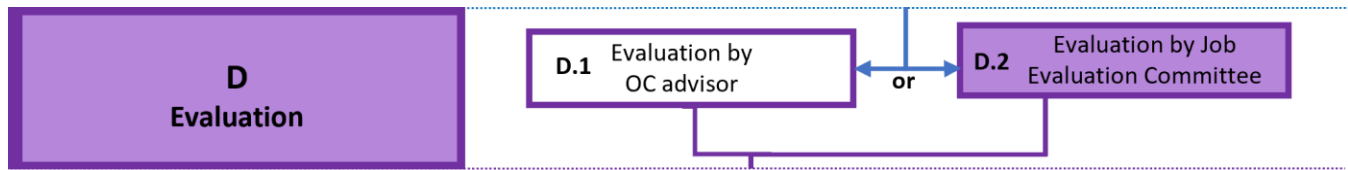


Figure 1. High level classification decision process overview

Chapter 2. Job evaluation committees



(Extract from Figure 1, page 2)

Whether the evaluation of a job is carried out by a single evaluator or a job evaluation committee, organizations must ensure that all classification decisions are arrived at in a transparent, equitable and consistent manner, and that these decisions are appropriate and supportable.

Job evaluation committees contribute to sound classification decisions by:

- increasing the knowledge base about the work, providing additional perspectives to the job evaluation, with enhanced insight into the work being evaluated within its organizational context
- supporting transparency in the evaluation process

Job evaluation committee members:

- are trained in job evaluation, according to the requirement of the *Directive on Classification* (B.2.2.7); the evaluator must understand classification including the job evaluation standards and the process of allocating jobs to occupational groups, including the use of the [Table of Concordance](#) and the [Guide to Allocating Positions](#)
- are not in a conflict-of-interest situation; they should not be in a position to benefit, either personally or operationally, from the results of the evaluation
- apply the job evaluation standards consistently and appropriately in accordance with classification policy instruments
- are aware and free of personal biases and do not make assumptions about the work being evaluated – namely, principles of consistency and gender neutrality are respected
- do not substitute their own knowledge for that of the manager, the employee(s) in the position(s) or the information provided in the job description
- do not make assumptions about the work or current hierarchical relationships as it introduces bias into the evaluation process

2.1 Requirements – When to convene committees¹

2.1.1 Job evaluation committees are required, at a minimum, when:

- evaluating standardized job descriptions
- using an occupational group or subgroup for the first time in an organization (department)
- the evaluation outcome may have a significant impact on departmental and interdepartmental relativity or result in a significant increase of salary expenditures
- there is the likelihood of a reclassification
- the evaluation outcome could be contentious or precedent-setting

¹ [Directive on Classification](#) section B.2.2.6

2.1.2 Other instances when a job evaluation committee could be convened:

- when additional expertise is required
- when a new organizational structure is being implemented with the potential to set new or impact existing relativities
- when the need for credibility and transparency is paramount, such as in contentious situations

2.2 Requirements – Composition of job evaluation committees²

2.2.1 A job evaluation committee is comprised of:

- at least one member who is designated as the chair
- a minimum of three rating members who are trained in job evaluation, including one who is delegated in organizational design and classification
- one or more rating members who represent(s) the organizations that use the interdepartmental standardized job description, if applicable
- members who are not in a potential (real or perceived) conflict of interest

Note: The chair does not have to be accredited.

2.2.2 Best practice

Why committee composition matters

The OC advisor in charge of the case determines the composition of the committee. The diversity of committee members' expertise is an essential benefit of classification committees. It enriches and informs the deliberations and ultimately results in stronger, more credible, transparent and easily defensible evaluations. As such, effort should be made to ensure that each committee member adds value to the deliberations, bringing a unique expertise and knowledge relevant to the evaluation. Although the usual number of evaluating members is three, in some cases a committee may consist of more than three evaluating members. This is often the case when evaluating interdepartmental standardized jobs where multiple departments may use the job description, and so the committee includes a representative sample of evaluators.

Line managers or subject matter experts

Managers may have one of two roles in committees. The role of the sponsoring manager, who is involved in the submission of the job being evaluated, will be covered in subsequent sections. Line managers or subject matter experts (SMEs) who have a deep knowledge of the work being evaluated, obtained through experience and/or supervision of functions similar to those being evaluated, can and should participate as evaluating members on job evaluation committees.

While not mandatory, the inclusion of a line manager or SME on the committee can provide insight that may have a significant impact on the final outcome of a job evaluation. It promotes greater understanding, nurtures partnerships and builds trust in the job evaluation process, as well as buy-in for the job's implementation. Line

² [Directive on Classification](#) section B.2.2.7

managers and SMEs may ask questions based on deep knowledge of the realities of the work that OC advisors are simply not in a position to have.

The most powerful benefit of having a line manager or SME as a rating member on a committee is evident when the committee member challenges the sponsoring manager on important details of the job that have not previously been shared, and that make the difference in the evaluation outcome. Often these details are ones that the OC advisor would never know about but for their fellow committee member asking the right question at the right time.

When sponsoring managers see that the evaluators truly understand the complexities and challenges of the job, they are much more likely to accept a contentious classification decision without escalation to dispute resolution measures. However, including a rating member in a job evaluation committee that is not familiar with the job being evaluated can have the opposite effect.

The policy and supporting tools are not prescriptive in terms of the groups and levels of the evaluating members. However, it is necessary to use judgment to select members who will have a strong contribution to the decision. The evaluating manager or SME could be in a different occupational group or even the same occupational group as the job being evaluated, but preferably excluded or unrepresented and in a more senior role and not in a conflict of interest. Choosing a member who is in the EX occupational group is recommended.

OC advisors

Accredited OC advisors are experts in the specialized field of job evaluation. There are various advantages and drawbacks to a job evaluation committee that includes two or more OC advisors as evaluating members.

Benefits:

- allows additional opportunities for those learning the discipline of OC to gain experience in evaluation
- is often faster to organize and conduct the assessment and saves time and resources in the long run
- allows for a more experienced OC advisor to contribute evaluation expertise and knowledge transfer on a particular assessment method or standard to the other members

Disadvantages:

- having only the OC perspective can result in shared biases
- missing details and elements of importance to the work being evaluated
- lack of experience could make it possible to sneak through certain decisions
- client's perceived value of the decision can be diminished

Interdepartmental vs. departmental job evaluation committees

The use of an interdepartmental job evaluation committee is recommended when:

- the classification decision relates to jobs found in many or most organizations and may be precedent setting for the core public administration
- interdepartmental relativity concerns are at issue
- an organization does not have a sufficient pool of trained committee members with the particular expertise required for the purpose of objective deliberations

Note: If the new group/subgroup is introduced through the use of an existing interdepartmental standardized job description, a committee will still need to re-evaluate the new group (and level) to ensure that the department's mandate (where the new group is now to be used) is met and that the value remains the same in this new context.

2.2.3 Why convene a job evaluation committee when not strictly required by policy to do so?

New decisions should be created only where there are no pre-classified standardized job descriptions in the core public administration that are an accurate reflection of the work. Therefore, there should be less need for a job evaluation in committee. Job evaluation committees are time-consuming. There is a significant investment of time and resources to organize committees, to participate in them, and to review and sign the reports.

However, since committees can increase the transparency and fairness in the evaluation process, they may make dispute resolution processes easier. Dispute resolution processes include disagreements with clients regarding OC decisions, proposals for deputy head-directed decisions, job content and effective date grievances, classification grievances, and defending decisions in federal court. Ensuring that decisions are as transparent and well-informed as possible at the initial evaluation stage by holding a committee can increase confidence in the decision and reduce the likelihood of these processes. This in turn saves resources, time and money in the long run.

2.2.4 Reclassification vs. new position

The review of a job has three main outcomes:

1. Group and level are maintained. This can occur in two ways:
 - a. no changes to the previous evaluation ratings or
 - b. changes to the previous ratings but with no impact to the level
2. Reclassification: Sections B.2.2.4 and B.2.2.5 of the [Directive on Classification](#) outline the requirements for reclassification. When these requirements are not met, new positions must be created rather than the reclassification of existing positions.
3. Creation of a new position – if significant changes to the job occurred (i.e., modifications to the required qualifications).

One of the aspects that needs to be addressed when evaluating jobs is whether the review of the SP should result in the review of a position or in the creation of a new position.

As part of the analysis, it is important to determine whether the changes in duties are part of a **natural evolution of work within the same work continuum**. This means that, over time, there is a progression in the scope of responsibilities for the job within the work stream context. This growth in the work may change some of the factor ratings but not necessarily constitute a reclassification.

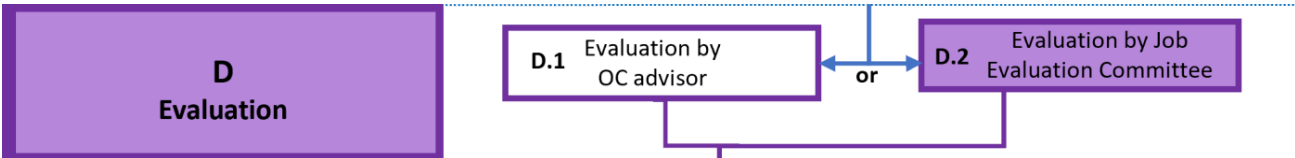
Here are some examples of evolution in work responsibilities:

- The work has evolved from participating in projects as a team member to leading projects
- The work has evolved from conducting assigned/project-related research and analysis to organizing and planning specific program/project files
- The work has evolved from conducting routine activities following established guidelines, methods and procedures to conducting more non-routine activities requiring adaptation of methods and procedures

Removal or addition of supervisory responsibilities can still constitute work within the same continuum; however, each situation needs to be considered on a case-by-case basis.

Note: A promotion in an official development program is not a reclassification; a new position must be created. A reclassification requires a classification decision that is separate from the staffing action.

Chapter 3. Job evaluation committee decision process overview



(Extract from Figure 1, page 2)

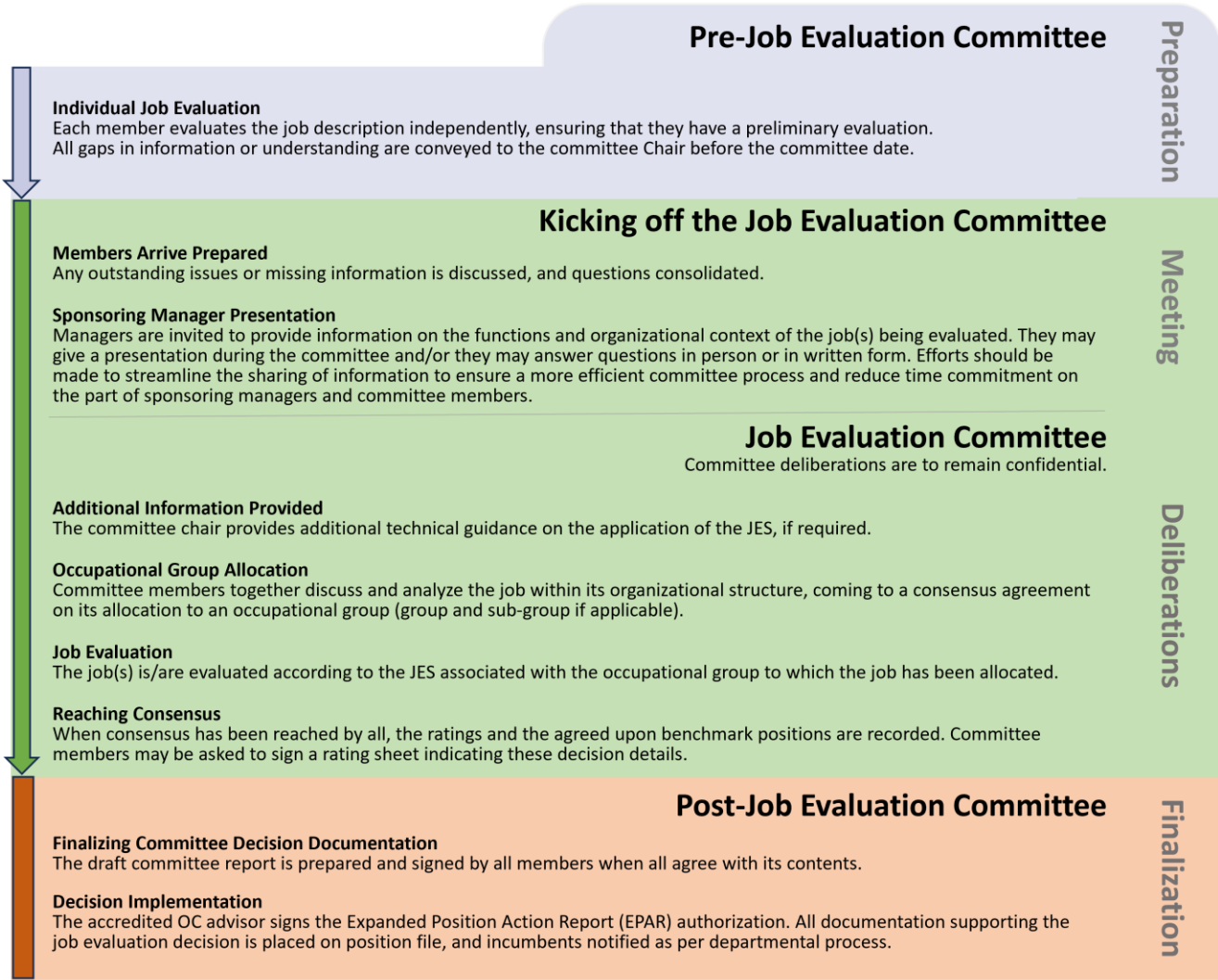
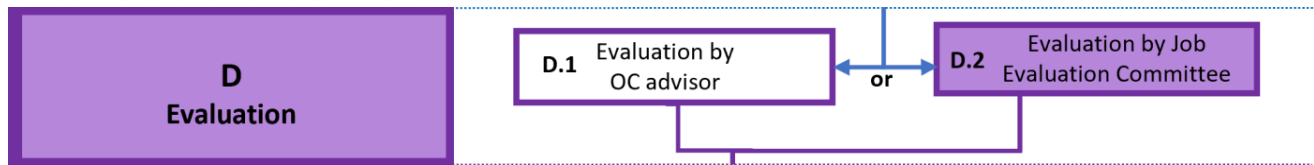


Figure 2. Job evaluation committee decision process overview

Chapter 4. Rating members of classification committees



(Extract from Figure 1, page 2)

4.1 Role of rating members on job evaluation committees

Rating members on job evaluation committees are expected to arrive prepared to share, discuss, debate and come to consensus on the evaluation of the subject job(s).

4.2 Responsibilities of rating members

4.2.1 Prior to the committee meeting

All rating members of the job evaluation committee tentatively evaluate the job(s) independently before the committee convenes.

If, during the course of the tentative evaluation, members have questions that require clarification that are paramount to the evaluation outcome, these should be shared so they can be answered. Questions may be submitted to the job evaluation committee chair prior to the committee so that the chairperson can obtain additional information or documentation and be prepared in advance, ensuring that all relevant information is gathered before the committee convenes. Additional supporting documentation may be shared with all the rating members prior to the committee, if applicable.

Any questions pertaining to job evaluation methodology or technical guidance should be directed to the committee chair.

4.2.2 During the committee meeting

Job evaluation committee members are expected to maintain a professional, respectful and collaborative approach, maintaining an awareness of the purpose and objectives of the job evaluation committee.

Expected approach

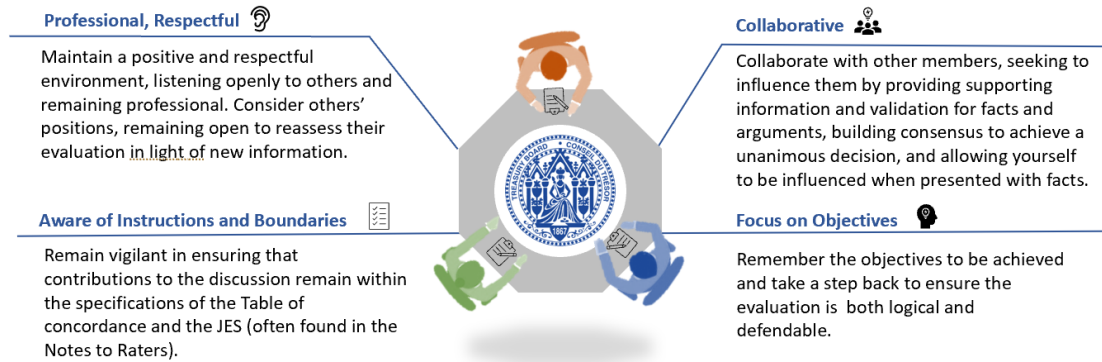


Figure 3. Expected behaviours of job evaluation committee members

Rating members can ask clarifying questions to ensure that they understand the facts before the decision is rendered. Additional information may be sought before, during or after the committee. The chairperson advises and leads the approach to obtaining the information and ensures that it is distributed to the members. Members should ensure that pertinent information is captured in the final report.

Committee deliberations

Committee members must first arrive at a consensus on occupational group allocation, followed by a consensus on the job's evaluation. Every effort to get new information, help interpreting the information available, get other perspectives, get additional guidance should be made by the chair, as applicable.

The final decision is always arrived at by consensus rather than through voting or majority rule. The evaluation process is a search for the most appropriate rating. The committee makes every effort to resolve differences and reach an agreement on the rating. If a consensus cannot be reached, the impasse is settled using the departmental process.³

Committee deliberations occur *in camera*, meaning that they are to remain confidential as members discuss the case in sufficient depth to resolve differences. This confidentiality remains in place until such a time as the decision is signed and, in some cases, announced and implemented.

Note: When a job evaluation committee reaches an impasse and is unable to come to a consensus, resolution is sought through the applicable departmental impasse resolution process.

4.2.3 After the committee meeting

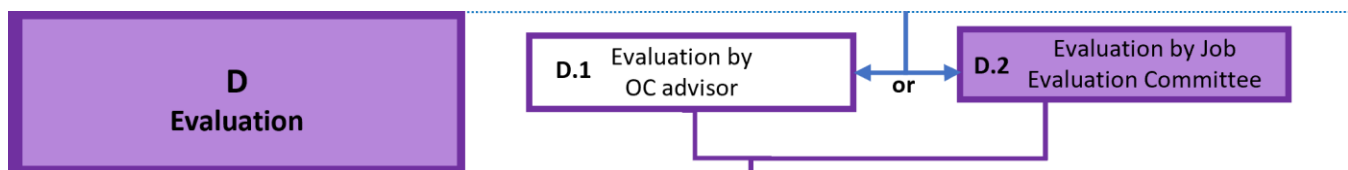
The job evaluation rationale is drafted by the chair, normally the accredited OC advisor who is a rating member on the committee, or another OC advisor under their guidance. It is then provided to the other committee members for feedback and approval. When all members agree with its contents, the document is signed by each

³ Section 4.1.5 of the [Directive on Classification](#)

member, and it becomes the official record of the job evaluation decision. At this time, the committee is dissolved.

Note: In some cases, pivotal issues surface during the committee meeting that require further work in order to evaluate the job. This may involve information that is not reflected in the documentation (e.g. job description or organizational chart). In such instances, the committee has the latitude to complete a conditional evaluation pending the completion of specific requirements. It may be that missing information must be included in the documentation before the decision is finalized. Changes may be required to the job description to ensure that it reflects the duties and organizational context of the job being evaluated. The committee members may have additional questions for the sponsoring manager that need to be answered in order to confirm a rating. In these cases, the responses and/or amended documentation are shared with the committee members for verification before the decision is finalized. The committee may agree electronically, or they may prefer to re-convene if further discussion is necessary. When all of the additional information and documentation is assessed and final consensus is reached by all of the members, the chair must prepare the committee report and job evaluation rationale for the committee members to review and sign.

Chapter 5. Chairing classification committees



(Extract from Figure 1, page 2)

5.1 Role of the committee chair

The role of the chair is to provide leadership and ensure that the rating members of a job evaluation committee fulfill their mandate in evaluating and rendering a decision on the rating of a job.

5.1.1 Who can chair a job evaluation committee?

Job evaluation committees can be chaired by either an accredited OC advisor or a non-accredited OC advisor under the guidance of an accredited OC advisor.

5.2 Responsibilities of the committee chair

5.2.1 Prior to the committee meeting

The committee chair:

- reviews all information available, ensuring that all required information to evaluate the job description has been gathered
- determines whether a departmental or inter-departmental committee would be most appropriate and recruits the appropriate participants, obtaining their agreement to participate as rating members
- schedules the committee meeting
- answers questions from the rating members before the committee convenes, as applicable
- contacts the sponsoring manager to invite them to provide a presentation to the committee:

- explain the added value of the presentation, clarify their role toward the presentation and the committee's expectations to that regard
- the presentation to the committee should include the functions and organizational context of the job description(s) to be assessed. If the manager chooses to make a presentation to the committee, the chair is responsible for scheduling the presentation at the beginning of the committee meeting
- regardless of whether the manager makes a presentation, effort should be made to ensure that they are available during the committee deliberations to answer potential questions that may arise
- prepares and shares with the other rating members a committee package that includes all necessary documentation for the evaluation of the job
- follows up with other rating members ahead of time to ensure that any questions that have arisen in their preparatory evaluations can be transmitted to the manager, allowing them to provide the information prior to or at the committee meeting itself

Training

Prior to the committee meeting, evaluating members should be trained on group allocation and standards (that could be considered during evaluation).

If applicable, sponsor managers who would present the job to the evaluating committee members could also be trained on presentation preparation, to provide accurate and complete information on functions and organizational context, etc.

The committee package

The committee chair provides each committee member with the appropriate documentation needed to evaluate the job. The committee members should have access to the evaluation documents in advance of the committee date – at least two weeks is a best practice. However, the preparation time required may vary based on the number of job descriptions being evaluated, the amount of information provided, and the complexity of the case. It is very important to ensure that the members have sufficient time to analyze the information, ask questions and receive answers from the chair when possible, and prepare for their participation in the committee. Committee members should complete a preliminary evaluation prior to the committee.

The committee package should:

- begin with a referenceable list of the contents of the package, and the role of the committee member receiving it (they are rating member and their particular value to the committee process, for instance)
- contain all relevant information for the committee members to complete their evaluation, such as:
 - subject job description to be evaluated, signed and dated by the manager, describing the duties and responsibilities of the job and indicating the effective date
 - an organizational chart, signed and dated by the manager, that depicts the organizational location of the position(s) and its relationship to the other positions in the same unit or division
 - the Job Validation Report(s), if one was conducted
 - a link to the Table of Concordance
 - a link to the job evaluation standards associated with any occupational group that could be considered during the occupational group allocation portion of the committee deliberations
 - position(s) and job history

- Relativity Analysis Report
- the job description(s) and evaluation(s) of the position(s) that supervise(s) the job being evaluated
- information pertaining to the business need behind the request and how the request purports to respond to that need
- any specific areas of complexity or concern that warrant particular attention by the members

Consideration – the committee package user experience

The committee packages should be easy to use and fully accessible by the users. The evaluation of jobs involves significant comparison of documents, so best practice is to ensure the most flexible way to access the documents to allow them to be assessed.

How the user experience can be optimized:

- Clearly label all documents. The reader should be able to easily identify each document in the package in three ways:
 - the Table of Contents, which lists all documents included in the package
 - the electronic name of the document
 - the visible title on the document when it is opened
- Allow for maximal accessibility. Users should be able to open each document independently to allow for side-by-side comparison

5.2.2 During the committee meeting

The committee chair is responsible for ensuring that the committee adheres to timelines, remains on topic and achieves its objectives. The chair is also responsible for taking notes of the discussions and decision points that will be used in the committee report and rationale. Sometimes another person might be tasked with taking notes on behalf of the chair, such as a junior advisor for training. In more complex cases, an observer may be asked to take notes to ensure that all details are accurately captured.

The responsibilities of the chair:

- **Open the committee meeting:** Upon arrival, the chair calls the meeting to order, introduces members to one another, and lays out the agenda. The chair will ask the members to share any questions they may have for the sponsoring manager and organize who will ask them. The chair may also ask the committee members to share the results of their pre-assessment. This helps determine which questions or elements to target for the sponsoring manager.
- **Introduce the sponsoring manager:** If the sponsoring manager has agreed to present to the committee, the chair has arranged a time for it to begin, usually allowing for some discussion time for the committee members prior. When that time arrives, the chair invites the sponsoring manager to join the committee and begin their presentation. The chair manages the allotted time for the presentation and ensures that all of the committee's questions are answered. When the presentation and subsequent question period have concluded, the chair thanks the sponsoring manager, who then leaves the meeting to allow for the committee member deliberations to begin.
- **Lead committee deliberations:** The chair facilitates the discussion, ensuring that the positions expressed by the rating members are given appropriate consideration. The chair provides additional information, as applicable, and technical expertise on the application of the job evaluation standard.

- **Closing the committee:** A best practice is to share a rating sheet, documenting consensus on the decision and the details of the decision (point ratings / degrees for the job being evaluated, and the associated benchmark positions) before the end of the committee meeting. The chair must inform the rating members of next steps and expected timelines in receiving the draft job evaluation rational that includes the committee particulars in the report.
- **In case of a non-consensus situation,** the chair should:
 - ensure that every effort is made to reach consensus, to the extent possible. This could include, but is not limited to, preparing and sending additional questions the sponsoring manager then sharing the responses with the committee members, reinviting the sponsoring manager for another presentation to the members, inviting new managers or a functional authority for additional information, or doing further research (e.g., new relativity)
 - initiate the departmental impasse resolution process

5.2.3 After the committee meeting

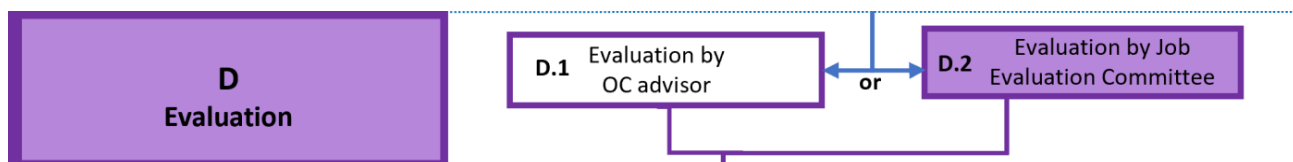
The job evaluation report is prepared (most often by the committee chair but could be prepared by other members) and distributed to all rating members for comment and approval.

When all members agree with its contents, they sign the final job evaluation report. When all members have signed the document, the chair informs the manager of the evaluation result.

The decision is then implemented by default and files are documented, both in the departmental HR system, and on the Position and Classification Information System+:

- The classification action form, also known as the Expanded Position Action Report (EPAR), documents the authorization to apply the decision to positions
- Once a position is created, the accredited OC advisor with delegated authority signs the EPAR
- When interdepartmental job evaluation committees are held in which the accredited OC advisor(s) on the committee (the chair or rating members) are from another department, the EPAR is signed by an OC advisor who is delegated at the department implementing the decision
- All documentation supporting the job evaluation decision is placed on the position file
- Incumbents are notified according to departmental process

Chapter 6. Observing a classification committee



(Extract from Figure 1, page 2)

Classification committee observers can attend the committee, but do not participate as evaluators in the decision-making process.

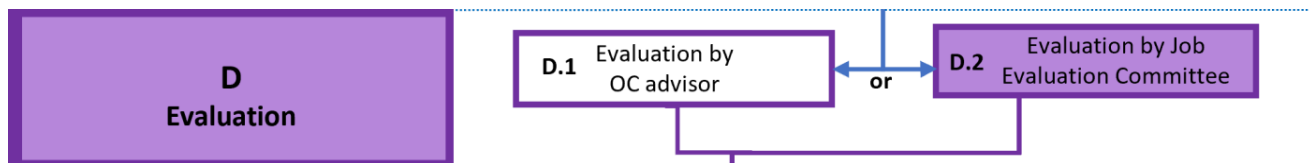
Most often, observers are OC advisors, with the objectives of:

- **Non-accredited OC advisors:** furthering their knowledge of the job evaluation committee process, to observe in anticipation of chairing their first job evaluation committee
- **Accredited OC advisor:** supporting and coaching trainees in chairing a job evaluation committee
- **HR advisors in other HR disciplines:** furthering their understanding of the job evaluation process
- **Other:** depending on the situation, it could be acceptable to invite other people to observe a job evaluation committee. Those people may or may not be employees from the core public administration, such as union representatives.

Note: In all cases, all evaluating members must approve the presence of one or more observers. In addition, the acceptable number of observers may vary depending on various parameters, including whether the job evaluation committee is done virtually or in person. Observers should not influence the committee members or the outcome in any way.

In the latter case, the number of people allowed to observe a committee could be limited according to the size of the room, or to avoid having so many observers that it would become disturbing for the evaluating members. Similarly, the observers' cameras and microphones, in the case of a virtual committee, should always remain off. They should also refrain from communicating electronically with the rating members during the committee meeting.

Chapter 7. Job evaluation rationales: single evaluators vs. committees



(Extract from Figure 1, page 2)

Whether a decision is made by a single evaluator or evaluation committee, both require justification, supporting information and arguments. The main difference between the two is the number of people who contributed to the decision and the format of report that is prepared.

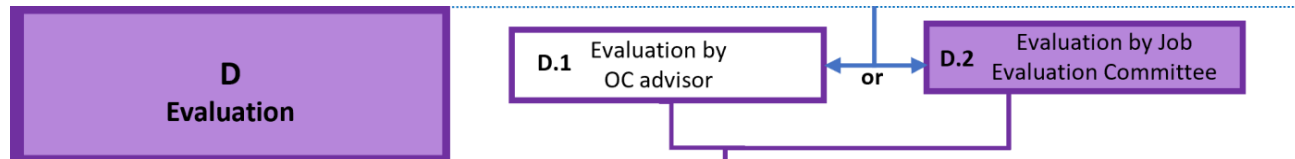
The job evaluation rationales are required for both types of decisions and contain the same decision justification information, but committee decisions contain additional committee-specific information outside the justification of the decision. This is the committee report, and it includes:

- committee member names and titles
- when a presentation is made, a summary of the information provided by the sponsoring manager, containing the salient points presented and, if available and pertinent, the presentation itself may be placed on the decision file
- a committee deliberations section to broadly explain what the committee took into consideration to arrive at the evaluation consensus, including the evaluation that required discussion, and a summary of decision points (this section is not intended to discuss individual member's ratings or approaches or to disclose where consensus was difficult to reach)

- committee member signatures authorizing the decision

[Templates](#) include options for single or committee evaluations. They also contain additional indicators about the distribution of information in the justification.

Chapter 8. Incumbent-oriented position specifics



(Extract from Figure 1, page 2)

Job evaluations using an incumbent-oriented method differ from other types of evaluations. As mentioned in reference guide titled “Job Evaluation,” the allocation of the position to the occupational group, group and subgroup is determined by the [classification authority](#), likely by the mean of a job evaluation committee, but the classification **level** is assigned to the position by a committee of peers based on the assessment of qualifications, accomplishments, publications and recognition for the incumbent’s expertise.